1. MfS, ZAIG, Nr. 25/89

2. Chronik Der Mauer: 1989 https://www.chronik-dermauer.de/en/chronicle/_year1989

3. Ironically, even without the fraud, the SED would certainly have received a solid majority. But, as usual, the charade was played out. At every polling station, the mechanics of voting was designed to expose anyone voting against the SED or political parties allied with the communists 'National Front' list of candidates. If the voters wanted to vote 'yes', it was sufficient to simply fold the voting slip into the ballot box. A 'no' vote, on the other hand, only counted if all candidates on the list were crossed out individually in a special voting booth, where the eyes of the election workers were focused. (A 'no' vote was only recognized if the voter neatly crossed out every single name on the list with a pen provided. Any deviation from this would render the voting slip invalid.)

4. Wahlbetrug 1989 – als die DDR-Regierung ihre Glaubwürdigkeit verlor, https://www.bpb.de/politik/hintergrund-aktuell/290562/1989-wahlbetrug-in-der-ddr

5. 'In isolated cases, they accused the election commissioners of electoral fraud and demanded that they be allowed to count the dissenting votes personally. Such provocations were rejected by the election commissioners, whereupon the individuals left the concerned polling stations without further comment.' While there was a general recognition of the seriousness of the situation, the Stasi had extremely little idea that this activity could be more than a temporary irritation.

6. By late evening, opposition observers knew that the results in the individual polling stations had turned out significantly different in some cases. In Berlin-Weißensee, for example, there were 83 per cent 'yes' votes, but also many 'no' votes and abstentions. Ten, sometimes up to 20 per cent, votes against were also documented in other parts of the GDR. The discrepancy was similar in the Berlin districts of Friedrichshain, Prenzlauer Berg and Pankow, but also in Naumburg, Potsdam, Erfurt and Jena. With